



THE WITCHER®

SECRET OF THE ELVEN GOLD

An adventure for use with The Witcher Easy Mode



CD PROJEKT RED®



Secret of the Elven Gold

Secret of the Elven Gold is designed to work with the rules presented in *The Witcher Easy Mode*, a free introduction to *The Witcher TRPG* available from *DriveThruRPG*. If you are using the pregenerated characters from Easy Mode, the following information can help players understand who the characters are, what they've been up to recently, and how they can be integrated into this adventure.

Pregenerated Character Recent Histories

Kaska Torma

A veteran of the Second Nilfgaardian war, Kaska Torma left the army to open her own practice in Ban Ard. She still keeps up with her war buddies, including **Ada of Ban Ard**, and **Fergus of Ban Ard**. A local merchant named **Vargus Bartok** recently hired her to join a crew escorting him to Afon Mynydd, a village in southern Kaedwen. The pay was good for a three week contract, and considering the opportunity to see **Fergus** at his "Missing Arm Inn" in Afon Mynydd, she accepted.

Ada of Ban Ard

After surviving the Second Nilfgaardian War despite serving in the infantry, Ada retired from the army. She still keeps in touch with her war buddy **Kaska Torma**, who patched her up more times than she cares to admit during the war. She now works as one of the merchant **Vargus Bartok's** two bodyguards. His other bodyguard is **Orban Madras**, who she has a good working relationship with. Her boss is heading on a three week trip to south-

ern Kaedwen with a crew he's put together to put an end to a problem facing his business, so she's going too, to protect him. It's her job.

Orban Madaras

Previously a problem solver for hire, Orban has been working as a bodyguard for **Vargus Bartok**, alongside **Ada of Ban Ard**, with whom he has a good working relationship. Orban has come to appreciate the steady pay and his employer has come to appreciate his delicate hand for sensitive matters. The boss is heading on for three week trip to southern Kaedwen with a crew he's put together to put an end to a problem facing his business, for which he needs Orban's expertise.

Aneurin the Bold

A musician from deep down to the very core of his soul, Aneurin lives to travel the world and pen his experiences of The Continent in verse. When he can come up with an excuse, he likes to travel with the mage Aislinn Veil, who he met in Redanian high society. **Vargus Bartok** recently hired him to write a song about a local legend in the south of Kaedwen in order to spread word of it far and wide. He just joined a caravan heading from Ban Ard to Afon Mynydd on the family's request to begin his research.

Aislinn Veil

A Mage, trained in Aretuza. After graduating, Aislinn Veil's magical research has been focused on ancient elven ruins. Her bard friend Aneurin the Bold recently tipped her off to the trail of an undiscovered elven ruin in southern Kaedwen, which might have a connection to an artifact she acquired quietly, a hexagonal

Credits

Writers

James Hutt

Cover

Grafit Studio

Layout & Design

J Gray

Editing

Cody Pondsmith

J Gray

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key pulsing with magic, made of crystal clear glass. Curiously, daylight, and only daylight, that flows through the glass becomes tinted red. As luck would have it, she found a group heading south to join, put together by the merchant Vargus Bartok with similar goals. She hopes the three week journey will be interesting.

Luskar of Hagge

One of the few remaining Bear School Witchers, Luskar is no stranger to hardship. Traveling alone, which suits him, as he prefers to be alone, he takes on occasional Witcher contracts for money. This particular contract isn't something he would usually take on, as it requires compromising some of his values, but it also comes with an additional layer of curiosity that interests him. During his time at Haern Caduch, he knew another Witcher named Jacos of Skellige, who took a contract almost exactly like this one, same location in Kaedwen, same target, a Wyvern which the client, a Kaedweni noble with the same unfortunate name, Darlington, believes to be a dragon, a common mistake. Perhaps he feels like it will be good to triumph here where another Bear failed. It's hard to tell, because Luskar's emotions have been dulled to the point of non-existence by the mutations he underwent in order to become a Witcher. Yet, he looks forward to it.



Background (Read Aloud)

The caravan's wheels, eight oaken circles divided among two covered wagons, have been keeping up nicely with the poor conditions of the road, as have your two horses. The trip up until now has been peaceful, running south from Ban Ard along the base of the Blue Mountains, the ultimate destination of Afon Mynydd now only a half day away. At the bequest of Vargus Bartok, the dwarven merchant leading your trip, the caravan pulls just out of the sight of the road among the trees and you begin to set up camp for the night.

The Rest of the Story

Some of the characters understand that they've essentially signed up to kill some bandits. For some, this is the sole reason they were hired by Vargas. For others, they were hired to solve some of Afon Mynydd's other problems that Vargus sees as troubling his business, namely a lack of morale among his customer base. The Bandits which are troubling Vargus have discovered the Elven

ruin, but have found it too dangerous to loot, as it is too close to a wyvern nest. As they have been making a good living off of killing "adventurers" who come into the Blue Mountains in search of elven gold, they find their spot too lucrative to move from, despite its dangerous proximity to the wyvern. The wyvern itself is actually a juvenile, the child of another wyvern that died in combat with a witcher (who also died fighting the wyvern) in the elven ruin.

Setting

The characters have been hired for a three week job by Vargus Bartok. The story opens with the party driving a caravan from Ban Ard to Afon Mynydd. The caravan is ambushed by bandits. After repelling the bandits, the party arrives in Afon Mynydd, where they are treated to a business lunch by Vargus. Afterwards, the players form their own plan to tackle the two tasks that Vargus assigns to them. After an expedition into the Blue mountains, they discover either the bandit encampment or elven ruin they were looking for. After exploring/fighting with bandits in the location they discovered, they discover that it is connected to their other task. After they explore it as well, the climax takes place when they are surprised by a juvenile wyvern that swoops down on them hungrily from the skies, intent on having them for lunch.

Forces

This adventure is meant to be run with up to six players who are ideally running one of the included six pregenerated characters. While their use is by no means required, this adventure is built around them.

The Opposition will be

- **Bandits** are the most common foe the party will face. They are not to be underestimated.
- **Wolves** might attack the party as they explore the Blue Mountains.
- **Deer** can be hunted for their meat when encountered in the Blue Mountains.
- A **Wyvern Juvenile** will hunt the party for their meat during the climax of the adventure.

Set Up (Read Aloud)

After the tents have been set up around a small fire, Vargas Bartok gathers the players to go over with them his plan for the next three weeks:

Friends, new and old, bound in the covenant of mutual benefit, gather around me. In the morning we will arrive in Afon Mynydd, a town that represents half of my outfitting business in southern Kaedwen. If everything was going swimmingly, we would not be having this discussion. Yes, there are several issues plaguing the business environment in this area that we will solve during these three weeks. Allow me to explain.

One. Half of my shipments to Afon Mynydd are being stolen by bandits. This cannot continue.

Two. There has been an increase in the number of inhabitants of the settlement that are being killed or robbed in the mountains while they search for their rumored elven ruin filled with gold. This is unacceptable, as these “adventurers” are my best customers.

Three. For reasons unrelated to their mortality rate, morale among these “adventurers” is low. Many are wavering in their belief that there even is an elven ruin filled with gold nearby in the Blue Mountains. What they need is proof that the rumor is true, or barring that, something to lift their spirits. Ideally, proof.

Any questions?

The Hook

After Vargus is done answering questions, he eats some beef jerky and has a nightcap of Mahakaman spirit before retiring for the night in his tent. Allow the players to talk amongst themselves around the fire for as long as they want, for character development, to set up a night watch, or otherwise. When everyone is ready to sleep, the night passes. Sunrise begins with Vargus directing everyone to pack up camp:

Let's get going people, I want to be eating stew at The Missing Arm by noon!

Go to **Cliffhanger (Bandit Ambush)**.

Cliffhanger (Bandit Ambush)

Let Bartok order the characters around for a bit. Tents need to be loaded back into the wagons, maybe some cargo needs to be distributed more evenly between the two wagons, armor must be donned, maybe one of the wheels needs a gentle shove back into alignment. Easy DC:10 Skill checks can be sprinkled in here for flavor. Use the time to re-engage players at the table that are less invested in the action of the moment. If you are running this adventure for any new players, make sure they witness someone in the party make a single Skill check, as a tutorial of sorts. When everyone is engaged, read aloud:

The horses spook as armed men yelling loudly come running toward your wagons in two groups, one from the direction of the road, the other from further into the forest, as they run in to flank you.

As the fight begins, Vargus Bartok hides in a secret dwarf-sized compartment under one of the wagons and does not come out until the bandits are no longer a threat. The bandits are equal in number to the number of players plus two, and fight until only one bandit remains. The last surviving bandit will attempt to escape in the direction of the Blue Mountains. Do your best to make sure he either escapes or dies, but if he gets captured, have Vargus step in and knock him out, prohibiting the party from speaking to him until he wakes up after **Development (Lunch At The Missing Arm)**, after which interacting with him is detailed in the **Sidebar (Captured Bandit)**.

The two spooked horses attack whatever they are closest to on their turn in combat with their hooves until they are calmed, and will prefer to attack a bandit if it has to choose. Calming each of the horses is a DC:10 Riding check, and is impossible for the Bandits. Vargus Bartok will never be attacked by his horses and automatically succeeds any check to calm them. When he calms them down, he does so using their names, Buckthorn and Sloppy, and a gentle touch.

Both horses are unaccustomed to riders, and thus make poor mounts. When mounted on either Buckthorn or Sloppy in combat, a character must use their entire turn to attempt a DC:14 Riding check in order to remain on the horse. Should they succeed on the check, they may move using the horse's speed on that turn.

If either horse dies during the fight, the cargo from both wagons will be put onto the remaining wagon, and the players will have to walk alongside it. If both animals die, everyone has to get out and push, which is a real pain. If either of his horses die, Vargus is depressed for the rest of the trip, during which he self-medicates with Mahakaman spirit in order to press on.

When the bandits and spooked horses are dealt with, go to **Development (Arriving in Afon Mynydd)**.

Development (Arriving in Afon Mynydd)

When the party arrives in Afon Mynydd, the settlement is clearly in rough shape. The settlement is small, consisting of two sturdy timber buildings and a stout watchtower overlooking a collection of large tents.

The building's signs bears proudly a severed arm rendered in nostalgic detail. The further building's door is emblazoned “*Bartok Outfitters*”. Amid the tents, scrawny young men with

Fergus and Kaska

During the second Nilfgaardian war, Kaska was the doctor who amputated Fergus's arm. In her care, they became friends, a friendship that endures to today. Fergus will greet Kaska warmly, and wouldn't dream of charging Kaska to eat at his inn. When they first meet, Fergus has prepared a gift for her, a special deck of rare Gwent cards that give a +2 to the Tactics Check used to play Gwent. Many of its cards feature doctors in their art. To the right buyer it would be worth 100 crowns.

The Missing Arm

The Missing Arm is run by Fergus of Ban Ard. Characters can purchase a bowl of stew from him for 10 crowns that provides all the sustenance a character needs for a day. A mug of beer costs 5 crowns. Unless your characters plan on making their own food or buying rations from Hulda, this inn is where they should feed themselves. Going without food is pretty hard on an adventurer. Decide how much you want this to be a part of your game and GM accordingly. A -1 to all actions is a pretty good start for a hungry character.

hollow eyes armed with iron swords crouch around several small fires, roasting rabbits and other small game.

After parking the caravan behind *The Missing Arm*, Vargus Bartok calls out for Hulda Barrow, Manager of Bartok Outfitters, a tiny human woman, shorter even than Vargus, and asks her to unpack the wagons and set up a base of operations for the party in the nearby watchtower. After she nods, Vargus enters *The Missing Arm*, but not before asking the party to join him when they feel like eating lunch. For now, he needs a stiff drink.

If any members of the party choose to help Hulda unpack the wagons before joining Vargus for lunch, they make a good first impression on her. Later in the adventure, for the gameplay benefit of her goodwill, see the [Sidebar \(Bartok Outfitters\)](#).

When the players join Vargus for lunch, Go to [Development \(Lunch At The Missing Arm\)](#).

Development (Lunch At The Missing Arm)

Up until this point, this adventure has been heavily GM directed. This has been done intentionally in order to teach the absolute bare minimum new players need to know about playing the game in order to have fun. Past this point, the adventure opens up and expects players to plan for themselves to a degree, which is also imperative for your players to have fun.

Vargus expects them to work independently to do what he hired them to do, because your players are the *professionals* he needs. For this reason, Vargus should not leave The Missing Arm for the rest of the adventure, and should refuse to help if asked. Past this point, your players are the stars of the show.

The rest of this development should give your players the tools they need to be independent.

Make sure if they leave the beaten path, they end up back on it, thinking that it was their idea.

And if you are a new GM, welcome, and good luck.

The Missing Arm is a small inn, befitting a small settlement. It offers only a single room for rent, which Vargus has purchased in advance, where he will be found for the rest of the adventure, when he isn't at the bar. The inn is owned by Fergus of Ban Ard, whose lost his right arm in the Second Nilfgaardian War. Luckily, he was left handed. His new right arm is a prosthetic that Vargus gifted him, a leather arm topped with a sturdy cleaver of dwarven make in place of a hand. He uses this arm everyday to, among other things, prepare ingredients to make his famous stew, which is served promptly at noon, at which time The Missing Arm becomes a lively scene, full of adventurers from the camp outside that were unsuccessful in catching food in the morning. The adventurers that can afford it come for the stew and stay for the drink, continuing the lively atmosphere into the night.

If Kaska Torma is in the party, Fergus notices her immediately, and greets her warmly. After lunch is over, in between this development and the next, go to [Sidebar \(Fergus and Kaska\)](#).

Otherwise, Vargus is sitting in the back of the inn at a table with a large pot of stew in front of him, beckoning the players to join him. As they eat, he goes over his plan for their next three weeks:

*Friends, just think of this as the first bowl of the stew that **those** bandits wont be having!*

Serves them right. Damn bottom feeders had never worked for anything in their life.

After we are done here, take the rest of the day off.

Starting tomorrow morning, start work on these three jobs:

Find these bastards hideout in the Blue Mountains, recover my stolen property, and make an example of them. (If Orban Madaras is in the party, have Vargus wink at him)

*Find this elven ruin that these washed up "Adventurers" can't seem to locate in the mountains. You can keep what you find in there, as per our agreement. If you need supplies, you can buy them from **Hulda**.*

Leaving me alone. I have meetings booked solidly for these three weeks. I expect you to do the job I hired you for by yourselves. Give me enough space to do mine. Oh, and don't think about splitting up when you go out there. I need your numbers to send my message too, that's a part of it.

Allow your party to decide what they want to do next by themselves. Let them take as much time as they need.

Depending what they choose, go to either **Development (Bandit Hideout First)** or **Development (Ruins First)**.

If your players want to explore Afon Mynydd anytime during the adventure, go to the corresponding **Sidebar: (Bartok Outfitters)**, **(The Missing Arm)**, **(Watchtower Headquarters)**, or **(Adventurer Camp)**.

Development (Bandit Hideout First)

If your players have decided to tackle the bandit hideout in the Blue Mountains first, no matter how they decide to go about it, they will have to find it first.

Here's a couple of ways to make this expedition into the Blue Mountains fun for your players. Each day, try to put in 2-3 of the events from the following table. If they spend some days in the middle of their expedition outside the safety of Afon Mynydd for healing, give them a single event every other day. Picking randomly or choosing what sounds coolest to you are both fine. Don't double up on combat events in a single day unless Ada of Ban Ard or Luskar of Hagge is in your party, but don't feel like you have to use both combat events either. Don't use the same event twice if you can help it:

Roll	Event
1	They discover a clue to the location of the elven ruins, from Development (Ruins First) . If they change course, go to Development (Ruins First) .
2	Your players encounter a pack of Wolves equal to the number of players, eager for a meal. It is a DC:15 Awareness Check to notice them before they attack!
3	Your players encounter a Bandit patrol, equal to the number of players minus one. If any are captured, see Sidebar (Captured Bandit) .
4	Your players run into a team of three "adventurers" heading back to Afon Mynydd. Use them to steer your players with hints and gentle nudges if you wish.
5	Your players stumble upon a secluded glade where a young stag is eating from a berry bush. It doesn't see them yet. Use the Horse Statblock .
6	Your players witness a Wyvern flying directly over their heads, disappearing into a crevasse far into the mountains. If the party changes course to follow the Wyvern, after another day of travel (using this event table) they arrive at the base of the crevasse, they discover the location of the elven ruin. Go to Development (Elven Ruin) .

Players arrive at **Cliffhanger (Bandit Hideout)** at sunset, at the end of the second day that they look for it.

Bartok Outfitters

Bartok Outfitters is ran by Hulda Barrow, a very short woman with a shy disposition. She will give characters that made a good impression on her 20% off their first purchase if they promise not to tell Vargus. Hulda won't sell characters ingredients if they don't know how to use them.

Item	Cost (Crowns)
10 Crossbow Bolts	10
10 Arrows	10
20m of Rope	20
Torch	5
One day of Rations	10
Ingredients to make 1 Swallow Potion	30
Ingredients to make 1 dose of Clotting Powder	20
Ingredients to make 1 Broadhead Bolt	10

Watchtower Headquarters

A thick octagonal tower. Inside, on the first floor, a headquarters has been set up for the party. They can rest here and be undisturbed at night. The second floor is the perfect place to keep watch, giving an additional +2 to any Awareness Check.

Adventurer Camp

The “adventurers” that live in this camp are not very good at their chosen jobs. Many are peasants that can hardly hold a sword. Most refuse to leave the encampment due to the bandit threat. Some are depressed, having been unsuccessful in one too many their expeditions into the mountains. These adventurers should be found all around Afon Mynydd in order to bring the settlement to life. They also are good delivery mechanisms for giving a struggling party gentle hints and nudges.

Captured Bandit

In the adventure there are several points where a bandit could be captured alive by the players. Such a bandit will likely be interrogated. Use this interrogation to give your players one of the events from **Development (Ruins First)** or **Development (Bandit Hideout First)**, depending on your party's plan.

Development (Ruins First)

If your players have decided they want to tackle the elven ruins, they will first have to find it. Your players have already come up with their own plan. Play along, providing them with 1-2 events per day they spend on expedition outside Afon Mynydd from **Development (Bandit Hideout First)**. Every second day they spend purely healing outside the safety of Afon Mynydd, they should also encounter one of these events.

While their plan is ongoing, sprinkle in some of these events along the way so they know they are on the right path. Don't reuse them, but feel free to pick whichever ones make the most sense for your players.

Roll	Event
1	Your players stumble on a lone marble pillar depicting a group of elves descending from a mountain to pick berries and returning to a palace on it's false peak. Nothing is to scale, and the location of the palace cannot be determined from the carving,
2	Your players stumble on a crumbling section of an elven road heading further into the Blue Mountains. After following it for a while it crumbles away into the ground.
3	In Afon Mynydd, an adventurer is trying to sell an ancient elven sword hilt to Bartok Outfitters for 30 crowns, which he claims he discovered at the base of a specific mountain. Hulda refuses, as they don't trade in antiques.
4	An adventurer offers to sell the party “valuable” information for 10 crowns. If they pay, they are told that a couple of years ago, a Witcher climbed a specific mountain to slay a Wyvern, but never returned. Those silver swords they carry are valuable.
5	While searching for the ruins, your players stumble upon the location of the Bandit Hideout. If they want to change course to attack it, go to Cliffhanger (Bandit Hideout) .
6	Your players discover a glass amulet depicting the Blue Mountains accurately, complete with a palace atop a false peak. The location of the palace can be determined from the amulet.

After around two days of searching, your players should reach the top of a specific mountain-top's false peak, arriving at Development (Elven Ruin).

Find some way for the bandit to escape or die from his injuries after the interrogation, as having an NPC around the party for an extended period can take away from your players sense of autonomy.

Cliffhanger (Bandit Hideout)

A number of bandits equal to the number of players plus two are present in the hideout when your players arrive. Three bandits are on watch, each manning one of the watchtowers. They aren't aware of the party... yet. The other bandits are inside the hideout behind a locked gate, drinking in the kitchen.

Ask your players how they want to approach the bandit hideout. Ask them what their plan is.

Like before, whatever they want to do is exactly what they are going to do.

Here's how to be *prepared for anything* they want to do:

Your players plan might hinge on any of the following: Stealth, Trickery, Climbing, Brute Force.

All of these (and more) can be resolved with skill checks.

For this adventure, when in doubt, use a DC:14.

DC:10 = Easy Skill Check
DC:14 = Average Skill Check
DC:18 = Hard Skill Check

For anything that can't be resolved with a skill check or combat, you should say YES. An example of this type of thing would be *"I want to set the wall of the hideout on fire"*. Each time your players ask for something like this, what they are really saying is: *"Let's make this interesting"*. So say YES, and then make it interesting! Don't spend 5 minutes looking at the rules, either. Say YES and make it interesting, immediately! Make up your own rules if you have to.

Remember your players are playing characters that are professionals. Their characters have done this before, even the players playing them are new to roleplaying. Make sure to re-engage players that are participating less before beginning any combat.

If the bandits are alerted, the bandits on the watchtowers enter combat immediately. The rest of the bandits rush to their weapons and armor in the armory and enter the combat two rounds after they are alerted. They all fight to the death.

In addition to the loot on each of the Bandits, the hideout yields:

- Two Verden Archer's Hood (3 Armor Value for Head)
- Three Double Woven Gambeson (8 Armor Value for Upper Body)
- Three Padded Trousers (5 Armor Value for Lower Body)
- 100 Crowns
- A large amount of food and assorted supplies in crates marked with the Bartok Family Seal.

The back wall of the bandit's armory is a

worked stone wall with a beautiful archway that the bandits obviously did not build themselves. It leads to the back entrance of **Development (Elven Ruin)**.

If the party has already fully explored **Development (Elven Ruin)**, go to the **Climax** whenever you feel it would be most surprising.

Development (Elven Ruin)

Within the mountain, the tight hallway opens up into a massive diamond-shaped cavern of elven-worked stone. A fissure in the ceiling of the cavern mirrors another fissure bisecting the first floor, scars left from a cave-in. Most of the four bridges that ran in between the second floor's four chambers have long since collapsed. On the southern end of the fissure, one such bridge has collapsed into a ramp leading to a chamber on the second floor of the ruin. Nearby the rubble ramp, two skeletons, one monstrous and the other mundane, rest upon the cold stone floor, a silver sword between them.

Specific features of the ruin are as follows. Check the included map for locations:

Wyvern & Human Skeleton: Skeletal remains of a Wyvern and a Witcher, who died in combat. Players can loot the Witcher's silver sword, his steel sword, and his Bear Witcher Medallion (these have the same stats as those possessed by Luskar of Hagge in **Easy Mode**). Several empty vials can also be found nearby. **Luskar of Hagge** knows this was **Jacos of Skellige**.

Teleporters: A network of four teleporters is located across the second floor of the ruin, each in various states of repair. Each teleporter has 1-3 functioning portals on it, which lead to the teleporter in the direction they are facing. An X on the included Teleporter Network Key indicates a malfunctioning portal. Keep this information hidden from the players. Attempting to use a malfunctioning portal causes a character to be appear right back where they were, and violently magically resonates them, which deals 1d6 damage to their Upper Body that armor does not negate. Additionally, any

Captured Bandit

In the adventure there are several points where a bandit could be captured alive by the players. Such a bandit will likely be interrogated. Use this interrogation to give your players one of the events from **Development (Ruins First)** or **Development (Bandit Hideout First)**, depending on your party's plan.

glass disks that the character is carrying shatter irreparably. If they have eaten recently, they are also likely to throw up unless they can make a DC:14 Endurance check. Aislinn Veil, if present, can determine which portals are malfunctioning without otherwise testing them.

Broken Bridges: Four bridges once connected the four rooms on the second floor in a ring. In two places, enough is left of both sides of a bridge that the gap can be jumped to travel between two rooms. Jumping the longer gap is a DC:12 Athletics check. The shorter gap is DC:10. A character that fails either check can attempt a DC:15 Athletics check to grab the ledge to save themselves, otherwise they fall into the Fissure, taking 3d6 damage to their Upper Body, which armor reduces, as normal.

Fissure: A wide fissure bisects the first floor of the ruin. The fissure is full of naked rotting bodies, some half eaten, mostly young and human. The stench at the bottom of the fissure is intense. A DC:14 Endurance check is required to not throw up. Climbing out of the fissure without a rope is a DC:12 Athletics check. Climbing with a rope is a DC:6 Athletics check. Falling into the fissure while carrying a glass disk shatters it irreparably.

Mural: This chamber features a large mural on its wall. The mural depicts a group of elves escaping from a world covered by a *blizzard* on white *ships*, which, by traveling through a *portal*, reach the *shore* of another world. Aislinn Veil, if present, knows that the mural depicts the exodus of the Aen Seidhe elves from their original world, and their arrival on the Continent.

Glass Chamber: This chamber is a storage room full of crates containing glass disks packed carefully in straw. Seven disks, each the size of a dinner plate and etched with a unique design can be looted:

- A boat, tinted white with a thin layer of dye.
- A bow, alongside a quiver filled with arrows. The arrowheads are tinted black.
- A blizzard, large enough to engulf several miniature cities etched in surprising detail.
- A portal, similar to those found in the elven ruin, probably etched from reference.
- A shore, complete with flora and fauna, treated with several vivid dyes. The most colorful piece.
- A staff, dyed red. The etching depicts it defeating several foes at once with might and magic.
- A shield, its face covered in etched ivy. The piece is incomplete, only the bottom half is dyed.

Lens Chamber: A long chamber, the far wall of which had been once painted entirely black. Four circular glass lenses, each the diameter of a typical human are affixed permanently to the floor in a line. Looking through the four lenses at the once-black far wall causes objects to appear much smaller than they actually are. A section of the floor at the base of the lenses the on the opposite end of the black wall is raised. Standing atop the raised section of the floor brings the center of the circular lenses to chest-height. A character can project an image on the black wall by using one of the glass disks found in the Glass Chamber and any light source. If a character projects the Blizzard, Boat, Portal, and Shore disks in that exact order, an entrance to the Secret Vault is revealed.

Secret Vault: A vault containing elven skeletons, their bodies reduced to mildew on their rotted leather armor. Their gold jewelry seems to have survived with only a layer of dust. Players can recover 300 crowns worth of gold from the vault. If Aislinn Veil is present, a keyhole is also present in the wall of the vault, which accepts her hexagonal key. The locked compartment contains an iron staff, dyed red. It is merely a replica of another, much more powerful weapon, but effective nonetheless. It is entirely possible that your players won't discover this room. This is okay. Don't tip them off about it, that would hurt their agency.

Name	WA	DMG	Effect
Iron Staff	+0	3d6	Long Reach Focus (2)

Bandit Stash: This area contains a pile of poorly made leather armor, clothing ripped into scraps, and other trash stripped from dead “adventurers” by the bandits, before throwing unceremoniously throwing their bodies into the **Fissure**. Much of it is covered in mold. All of it is worthless, providing no armor value, but if searched, 10 crowns can be found in a secret pocket sewed inside a ruptured gambeson. The good stuff has been sorted out already, and is stored in the **Bandit Hideout's Armory**. The holes in the corners of the chamber are used by the bandits as a toilet. Afterwards, clothing scraps from the pile are put to good use, for hygiene purposes.

The hallway in the back of the Bandit's Stash room leads to the back entrance of **Cliffhanger (Bandit Hideout)**.

If the party has already been to **Cliffhanger (Bandit Hideout)**, and has fully explored the ruins, go to the **Climax** whenever you feel it would be most surprising.

Climax

A Wyvern Juvenile swoops down on the party wherever they are. The Bandit Hideout or Elven Ruins are the best locations to do this in. Unless Luskar of Hagge is present to hear the beating of distant wings rapidly approaching with his supernatural witcher senses, your players have no time to prepare, as the monster is already upon them! If Luskar is present, he can call this out to the rest of the party, giving them 30 seconds to prepare.

Enter combat immediately. Despite the startling nature of the wyvern's entrance, this is not considered an ambush. This is a dangerous foe, and will seriously hurt your players. A character may die, especially if your party is lacking Luskar of Hagge, Ada of Ban Ard or Aislinn Veil. This is okay.

The Wyvern Juvenile is less intelligent than a fully grown wyvern, which comes off as recklessness in combat. It likes to bite the closest thing to it. If two targets are equally close to it, it will instead prefer to claw them each once. It will only use its tail barbs against a target that is behind it. As its wings are not fully grown, it will not fly during combat, not even to escape. The wyvern fights to the death.

Your players may try and hide from the wyvern. This is good roleplaying, and should be encouraged, but if *all* of your players try and hide behind something, or even worse, *attempt to escape*, have your wyvern smash through the side of whatever they are trying to hide behind, and bite the closest, most unfortunate player, all in one turn.

When the Wyvern Juvenile is slain, go to the Ending.

Ending

After the fight with the Wyvern, the party is paid if they return the stolen crates from the bandit hideout. Back at The Missing Arm, Vargus pays them a bonus for slaying the beast, bringing their total payout to 150 crowns per player. He even lets them keep the armor that they recovered from the bandit's armory, even though it is also his stolen property. Vargus offers to introduce the party to some of his business partners that might have work for them in the future, should they ever need such an introduction.

If Aneurin the Bold is present, he is asked to preform the song which he was hired to write for the patrons of The Missing Arm. Aneurin's song is a great ending point for this adventure. If he isn't present, the Vargus's offer of an introduction is fine as well.

Bandit

Loot

Iron Longbow, Hand Crossbow, Crossbow Bolts (1d6),
Aedirnian Gambeson, Cavalry Trousers

Academic Knowledge (Education DC:10)

Bandits are one of the most common threats on the road, but they are far from the most dangerous. You'd have a far worse time prying a ghoul out of you than dispatching a few bandits. But they can still be a significant threat in large groups. The vast majority of bandits are soldiers without an army, mercenaries who have no contract, or deserters from any one of the many armies flooding across the land. Simple sorts, bandits. The front ranks will charge with long swords. Any who can't will draw their crossbows. Bandits are usually looking for three things: safety, money, and something to take their anger out on. They aren't exactly easy to deal with but, unlike most monsters, they can be reasoned with. Maybe you can convince them not to try and kill you. Since they aren't hunting on instinct bandits will likely give up if you do enough damage to them.

However, some who travel in more tightly woven groups may fight all the harder if you kill their buddies. In the war-torn North, be a bit more wary. Lack of easily accessible food has driven some bandits to cannibalism. Cannibals often go a bit mad and attack wildly, refusing to give up even when half dead. If you don't want a fight, keep a wary eye on the roads.

Type	Humanoid
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INT	3
REF	6
DEX	5
BODY	5
SPD	4
EMP	3
CRA	4
WILL	4
LUCK	0

VIGOR	0
SAVE	4
LEAP	2
HP	20
STA	20
REC	4

Health	
20	
Stamina	
20	

Armor Values		
Head	0	
Upper Body	5	
Lower Body	3	

Skill Bases	
Athletics (9)	Endurance (10)
Awareness (9)	Resist Magic (8)
Brawling (12)	Resist Coercion (9)
Crossbow (9)	Stealth (8)
Courage (11)	Swordsmanship (12)
Dodge/Escapes (10)	Wilderness Survival (8)

Armor	
—	
Aedirnian Gambeson	
Cavalry Trousers	

Weapons				
Name	ROF	WA	DMG	Effect
Punch	1	+0	1d6	Non-Lethal
Kick	1	+0	1d6+4	Non-Lethal
Iron Longsword	1	+0	2d6+2	N/A
Hand Crossbow	1	+1	2d6+2	Range: 50m

Vulnerability	
Hanged Man's Venom Scoia'tael Archers take extra damage from weapons coated in Hanged Man's Venom.	

Wyvern, Juvenile

Type	Draconid
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INT	1
REF	10
DEX	10
BODY	10
SPD	7
EMP	1
CRA	1
WILL	6
LUCK	0

VIGOR	0
SAVE	8
LEAP	4
HP	80
STA	40
REC	8

Health	
80	
Stamina	
40	

Armor Values		
Head	8	
Upper Body	8	
Lower Body	8	

Armor
—
—
—

Skill Bases	
Athletics (14)	Endurance (18)
Awareness (16)	Melee (14)
Brawling (14)	Resist Magic (14)
Courage (12)	Stealth (16)
Dodge/Escape (14)	Wilderness Survival (16)

Weapons				
Name	ROF	WA	DMG	Effect
Claws	2	+0	3d6+1	—
Bite	1	+0	5d6	Poison (20%)
Tail Barbs	1	+0	4d6-2	Poison (50%)

Vulnerabilities	
Draconoid Oil Wyverns take extra damage from weapons coated in Draconoid Oil.	

Abilities	
Flight After spending a full minute stretching out it's wings, a wyvern juvenile can take flight as a movement.	Spit Venom As an action, a wyvern juvenile can spit a glob of acid up to 8m that deals 3d6 damage with a 80% chance of inflicting the Poison effect. For this ranged attack, the Wyvern uses their Athletics Skill Base (14).
Feral For the purposes of Awareness and Wilderness Survival, instinct gives them an INT of 7.	

Loot

Draconid Scales(1d6), Venom Extract (1d6), Wyvern Eyes (2)

Witcher Knowledge (Monster Lore DC:16)

Draconids accrue the most strange and fantastical legends around them. Something about this family of monsters inspires the storyteller in everyone. Wyverns are draconids, in the same family as dragons but far from being dragons. They are violent, primal beasts that stalk high mountain areas and hunt people mostly when they happen upon them. Wyverns have no predisposition towards virgins—they pursue any living creature they think they can kill and eat. It is true that wyverns like to swoop down on their prey from above and try to stay in the air if possible. Unlike dragons, wyverns can't breathe fire, but they can spit an acidic poison with great accuracy. That can make fighting a wyvern at range a daunting task. Luckily they aren't immune to everything but silver. While their hides are tough to pierce, they can be felled with regular steel weapons and magic, just like most other creatures.

When hunting a wyvern, start by preparing a draconid oil. Cover yourself from head to toe as much as possible to avoid acidic venom getting on any uncovered areas. Golden oriole potion is also a good idea, to negate poison effects. You should also stock up on ranged ammunition or make sure you know a few damaging spells. While a wyvern flies around its prey, a well-placed arrow or the like stands a good chance of knocking the monster out of the air, making it far easier to hit. While engaging a flying wyvern, be wary of their claws—they will try to slash at you as they fly by. On the ground a wyvern falls back to its fanged bite or the poisonous barbs on its tail.

Wolf

Loot

Dog Tallow (1d6), Wolf Hide, Wolf Liver,
Beast Bones (1d6)

Commoner Superstition (Education DC:8)

Not much to be said about wolves. Heh, they're bloody bastards that live in the woods and stalk travelers. They'll usually only attack in packs of five or six and fire'll make 'em back off. If ya have to fight 'em, make sure they can't circle around ya—they'll box ya in and attack from all directions. Terrible way to go if ya ask me. 'Specially bad since the war's been on. With all the corpses and wounded travelers, wolves are gettin' braver and braver. Have 'em in towns, pickin' off infants in no time. Heh, lotsa folk think they're a poor omen too. Can't count the number of prophecies and whatnot that start with a wolf. Let me tell ya, none of 'em are good.

—Rodolf Kazmer

Type	Beast
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INT	1
REF	4
DEX	6
BODY	5
SPD	7
EMP	1
CRA	1
WILL	4
LUCK	0

VIGOR	0
SAVE	4
LEAP	4
HP	20
STA	20
REC	4

Health	
20	
Stamina	
20	

Armor Values		
Head	0	
Upper Body	0	
Lower Body	0	

Skill Bases	
Athletics (12)	Endurance (10)
Awareness (7)	Melee (10)
Brawling (10)	Resist Magic (6)
Courage (10)	Stealth (12)
Dodge/Escape (10)	Wilderness Survival (10)

Armor	
	—
	—
	—

Weapons				
Name	ROF	WA	DMG	Effect
Bite	1	+0	2d6	—

Vulnerability	
Beast Oil Wolves take extra damage from weapons coated in Beast Oil.	

Abilities	
Scent Tracking A wolf can track a creature without visual or audible clues with no penalty.	Night Vision Wolves operate in areas of dim light with no penalties.
Feral For the purposes of Awareness and Wilderness Survival, instinct gives them an INT of 7.	

Horse

Type	Beast
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INT	1
REF	4
DEX	5
BODY	12
SPD	12
EMP	4
CRA	1
WILL	4
LUCK	0

VIGOR	0
SAVE	8
LEAP	7
HP	40
STA	40
REC	8

Health	
40	
Stamina	
40	

Armor Values		
Head	0	
Upper Body	0	
Lower Body	0	

Armor	
—	
—	
—	

Skill Bases	
Athletics (11)	Endurance (18)
Awareness (12)	Melee (10)
Courage (10)	Stealth (8)
Dodge/Escape (12)	Wilderness Survival (9)

Weapons				
Name	ROF	WA	DMG	Effect
Hooves	1	+0	2d6+2	—

Vulnerabilities	
Beast Oil Horses take extra damage from weapons coated in Beast Oil.	

Abilities	
Feral For the purposes of Awareness and Wilderness Survival, instinct gives them an INT of 7.	

Loot

Raw Meat (1d10), Beast Bones (1d10)

Afon Mynydd



- | | |
|----------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. Bartok Outfitters | 3. The Missing Arm |
| 2. Watchtower | 4. Adventure Encampment |

Bartok Outfitters



- | | |
|--------------|-------------------|
| 1. Store | 3. Manager's Room |
| 2. Storeroom | |

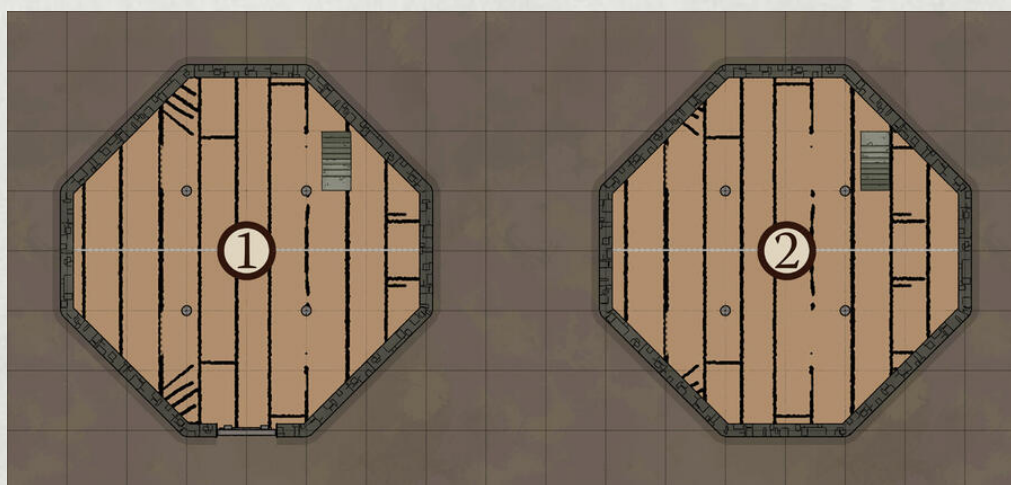
The Missing Arm



- 1. Bar/Kitchen
- 2. Room for Rent

- 3. Innkeeper's Room

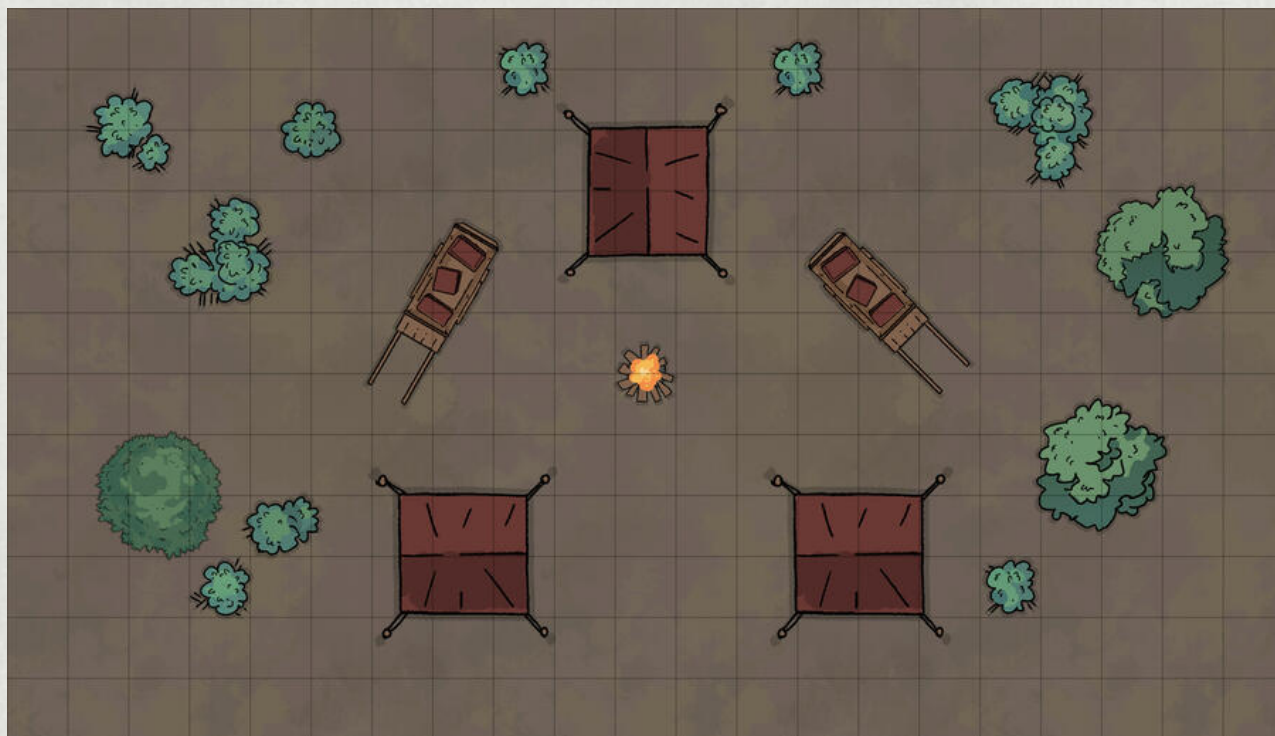
Watchtower



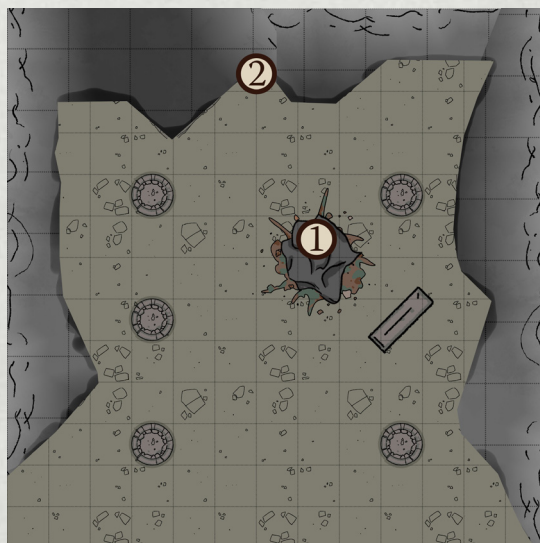
- 1. First Floor

- 2. Second Floor

Roadside Camp



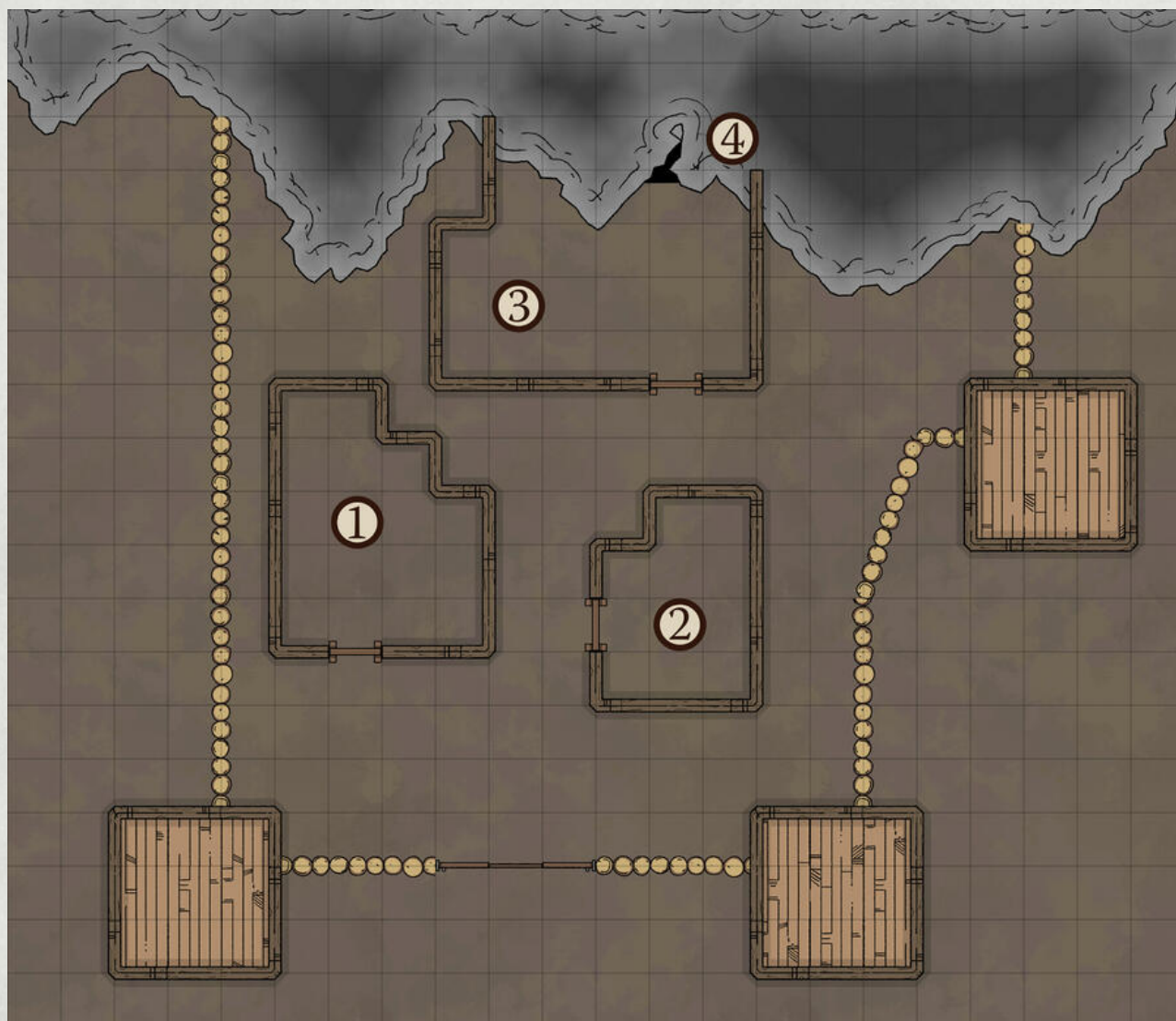
False Peak Entrance to Elven Ruin



1. Wyvern Nest

2. Elven Ruin Entrance

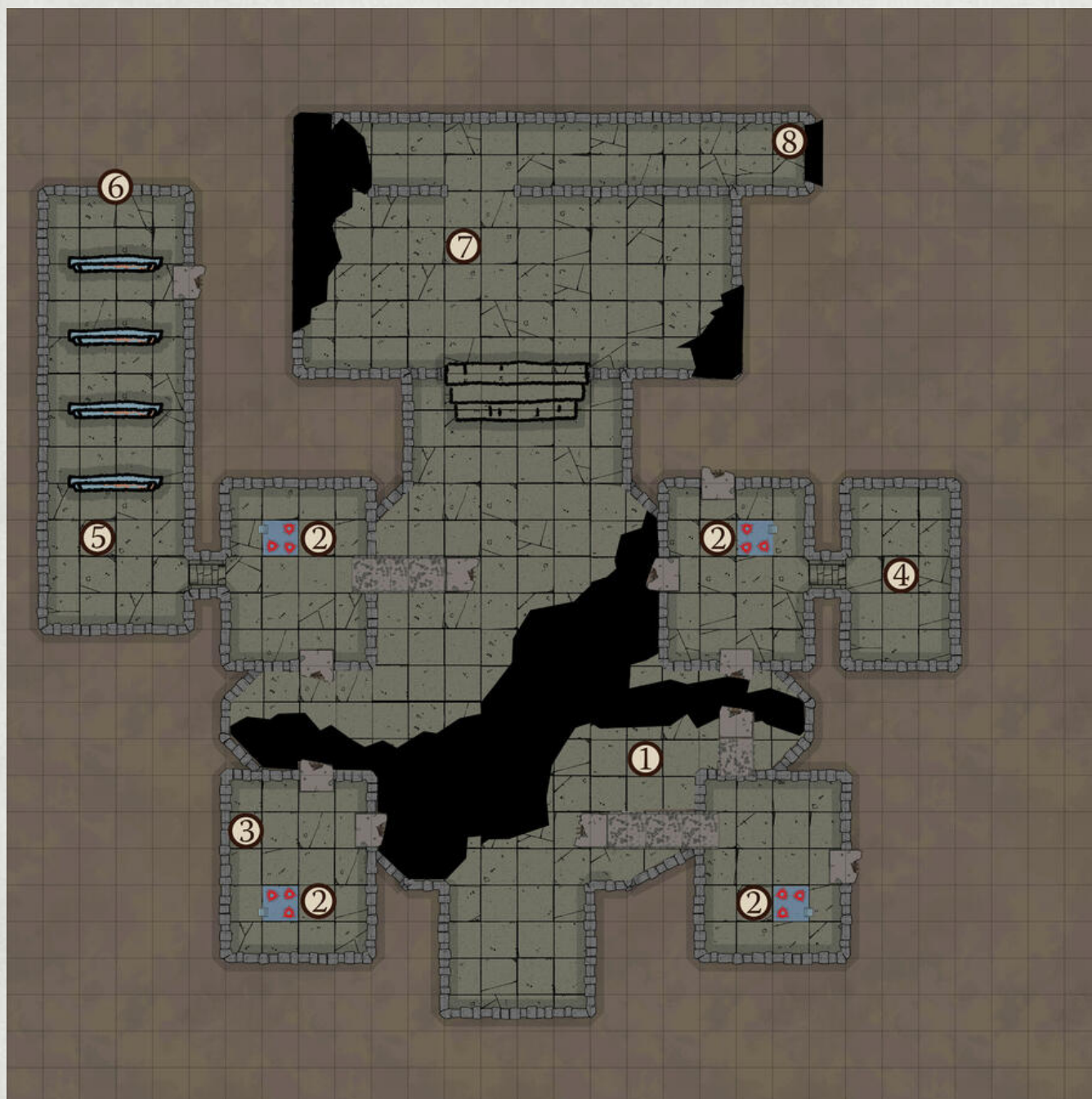
Bandit Hideout



1. Living Space
2. Kitchen

3. Armory
4. To Elven Ruin

Elven Ruin



- 1. Wyvern/Human Skeletons
- 2. Teleporters
- 3. Mural
- 4. Glass Room

- 5. Lens Room
- 6. Secret Vault
- 7. Bandit's Stash Room
- 8. To Bandit Hideout

Portal Network Key

